

NetFrame

working title
Version 0.5

These rules set out a method of handling movement and combat between Mobile Suits. The game is played across 5 turns, after which the team with the most victory points wins. Each player brings the same number of Frames, each with their own deck. A good default number is 3 per player, although with teams 2 each can be smoother. With many players teams are recommended over battle royale, though the rules support either playstyle. All frames a player brings should be from the same faction.

Victory Points

Victory points are obtained in two key ways:

- 1 point per enemy frame defeated
- Points equal to the defender score for each objective they successfully defended
- Points equal to the attacker score for each objective they successfully attacked

The battlefield

Terrain blocks movement and line of sight. Terrain that can be stood upon is classified as being on different levels.

Terrain Cards

It is recommended for each player to bring a terrain deck of 15 cards, of which between 2 and 3 should be objectives. These cards are shuffled, dealt and construct the battlefield. On the card is a grid, on which the frames move and ranges are reckoned. The border of the tiles indicate the elevation

black	ground level
dark blue	level 1
blue	level 2
light blue	elevation 3
red	impassible

Tiles that contain obstacles have a yellow dashing on their border and yellow diagonal lines. Tiles that indicate objectives have green lines, tiles that need a token placed on them have hatching.

Movement on these tiles is lateral and diagonal. The 8 tiles surrounding any one tile are all adjacent to it (so would count for melee attacks). Ranges are considered the same way (so you can consider the maximum range a square centered on the frame with sides of length twice the range).

Terrain cards



example of a terrain card

Prebuilt Terrain

If you prefer, instead of using the terrain cards you can use whatever terrain setup you have at your gaming table. Players should quickly agree at the start of the game what level each piece of terrain is, but as a quick rule of thumb, moving up one frame's height is roughly one level. The level indicates how much movement it takes to climb onto the terrain, and what can see what. In this case, for objectives you can either draw objective cards from the deck and place appropriate markers and tokens at a location of your choosing, or use pre agreed objectives, and the objectives on the cards can be used as reference. In this case, distances are measured with a tape measure and a fixed base unit should be established based on the scale of the miniatures. Deployment zones are 7 units away from the midline.

Setup

If using the terrain decks, each player deals out their terrain cards from their terrain deck in 2 rows of (nframes + 2) to make a grid. (for 2 players with 3 frames each that makes a 4x5 grid). Any relevant tokens are placed on the terrain cards. All objectives on these terrain cards are valid for this battle - you are de-

fending any objectives that are on your teams terrain cards.

Each player takes it in turns to put one of their frames in their deployment zone (The nearest edge of the row of terrain cards nearest them if using, else anywhere more than 7 from the center line). After all frames are deployed this way, shuffle the decks, and the player who deployed first receives the priority marker.

Card anatomy

Initiative: 	Marks when the card will resolve. Higher numbers resolve before lower numbers
Movement: 	How much to add (or subtract if its negative) to the movement for the action with this card
Attack marks: 	How much damage to deal at this location if this attack hits (symbol indicates damage type)
Attack range: 	Range of ranged attack
Block mark: 	Region that this card blocks for – shown by drawing that zone’s background as this shield shape instead of a plain box
Persistence mark: 	Indicates that the card stays on the field after resolving until its effects finish. N indicates how many turns that is.
Ability text:	Effects that happen when this card is played or resolved.
Type info: (bottom)	What type of card it is, and categorisation information. Used for deckbuilding.

The turn

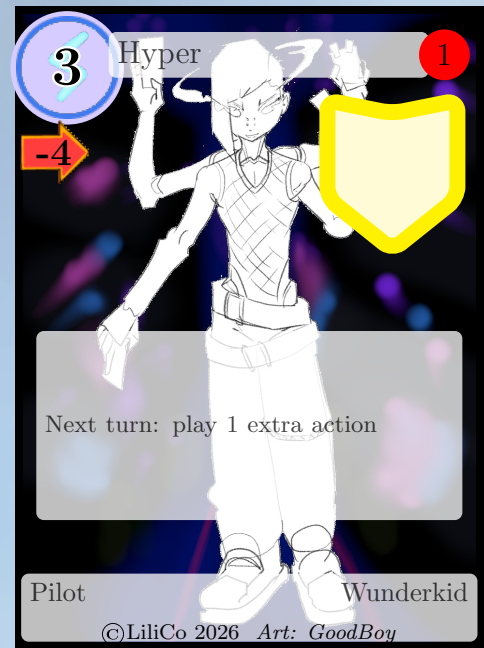
On each turn of the game there are 3 phases: planning, action and cleanup.

Planning

in the planning phase, simultaneously for each frame 5 cards are drawn from it’s deck, and from those 2 are chosen and placed facedown. The rest of the cards are put in that decks discard pile (if you are short of space, you can put the cards face up at the bottom of the deck). When the deck runs out, the discard pile is shuffled back in.



A Weapon Card



A Pilot Card

Echos of the fallen

If a frame has been defeated, at the end of the planning phase the player can reveal the top card of that frame's deck and put it sideways with the actions of a surviving frame. That card can also be used to block attacks this turn.

Status update

At the end of the planning phase, one status token of each type is removed from each frame.

Action

Each player declares the highest remaining initiative amongst the initiatives of their remaining cards.

Cards are resolved in order of the initiative value, starting with the highest. In the event of a tie, players take it in turns to choose one card at the current initiative to resolve, starting with the player with the priority marker and moving clockwise.

Card resolution consists of 3 steps: movement, effect, and attack. Movement can happen first or last.

Pre-combat Movement

The frame can move up to their base movement plus the movement modifier on the card currently being resolved steps in any direction. The frame can move either before or after attacking.

Movement penalties

It takes 1 movement to move up per level difference, and you cannot stop halfway up. It costs no additional movement to move down any number of levels. Obstacles cannot be moved through.

Effect

After movement is done, any effect on the card is applied. Effects are applied in printed order.

Attack

If the card has any attack listed, one target frame within any of the ranges may be chosen. For attacks without a range value, the target must be adjacent, and this attack is a melee attack. They are then the defender for this attack.

Line of sight

To select a target for a ranged attack the target must be:

- within the range of the target
- not adjacent to the attacking frame

Then draw a line starting from anywhere on the attacking frame to anywhere on the target. If there are no obstructions on that line, the target is valid.

The following count as an obstruction:

- Other Frames
- Impassible terrain
- Terrain at a higher level than the attacker
- Obstacles adjacent to the target
- Terrain at a higher elevation than the target adjacent to the target

If the defender has a block on their remaining cards in the same zone as any of the attacks that are in range, they must choose one of those cards to block. The attack fails and that blocking card is discarded (if its initiative hasn't been reached yet it never happens). Otherwise the attack succeeds, and the defender takes one damage per attack mark in the corresponding zone (high/mid/low). After finishing the attack the card resolution ends, and the card remains on the field to be used to block. (It can be helpful to turn it sideways to indicate that it's been resolved) If the defender fails to reveal any valid blocks they did have face down, those cards cannot be activated later in the round and are instead discarded.

Melee between levels

If the attack is a melee attack and the defender is at a different elevation to the attacker, the attacks are moved up one bracket per difference in elevation. Any attacks that are moved higher than High or lower than Low are considered out of range.

So for example, Frame A at elevation 1 attacks Frame B at elevation 3 with cleave, which has ~~XX~~ high and ~~XX~~ mid. The attacker is 2 levels lower than the defender, so the attacks are moved 2 stages down. The ~~XX~~ high end up ~~XX~~ low, and the ~~XX~~ mid are out of range. Conversely if Frame C at elevation 2 were to attack Frame A with Thrust (~~↗~~ mid), it would be moved one stage up, resulting in ~~↗~~ high.

Ranged attacks are not affected by elevation in this way.

Damage

Each frame can endure a number of hits on each zone indicated on the character card (default 4) after which they are destroyed. Destroyed frames are removed from the battlefield and can no longer contribute to the fight. Additionally any frame that has endured 2 or more damage in any location faces the following penalty corresponding to the location:

- | | |
|------|---|
| High | -1 initiative (reduce initiative on all actions by 1) |
| Mid | -1 cards (draw one less card to choose actions from) |
| Low | -1 movement (reduce base movement by 1) |

Post-combat Movement

If the frame did not move before applying effects and attacking it may move after finishing the attack.

Cleanup

Cards without a persistence marker and any cards with a persistence marker whos effects have finished are put into their respective discard piles. Cards with a persistence marker that are still active are set aside clearly distinct from the turn's chosen actions (they do not have active blocks). The priority marker then moves one step anticlockwise.

Status

Various cards apply certain status effects to frames. These status effects are marked with a counter added to the frame. As long as the frame has any amount of the status marker on it, the frame's stats are modified according to the status. The modification amount is the same regardless of the quantity of status counters.

Status: Various cards say that a frame will recieve one of the below status. As long as they have any amount of that status token on them, the noted effect applies.

Debuff

Stunned  (-2 init)

Dazed  (-2 card)

Slowed  (-2 mv)

Revealed  (chosen actions are turned face up)

Buff

Stimmed  (+2 init)

Lucid  (+2 cards)

Boosted  (+2 mv)

Status annihilation

If a frame would receives the opposite status to the status it already has, instead remove that many of the counters it already has before applying the difference.

Status application

The number of status counters on the frame indicate the duration of the effect. Each turn, after the planning phase finishes one of each status counter is removed.

Tokens

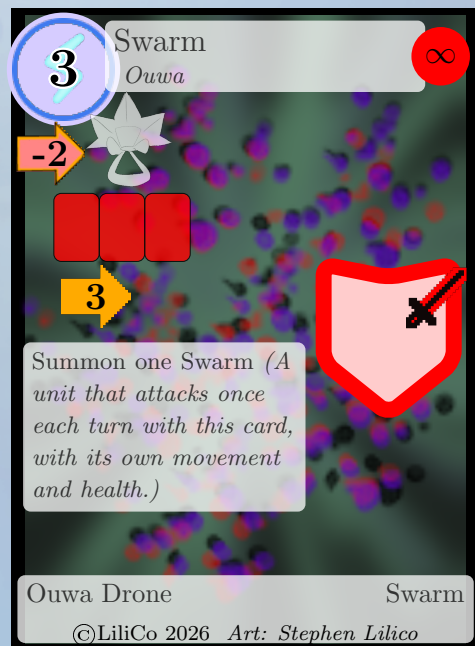
Terrain and various card effects create tokens. These can normally be indicated by anything you have around, coins, dice, whatever, as long as it is clear to everyone what it is. Dedicated token pieces are also manufactured for players who wish to use them.

If a token has a specified health stat, then it can be attacked by an opposing team the same way as a frame can be. Tokens never block, and they only have one health stat, so all damage from all zones affects its health the same. If it takes damage past its health stat, it is destroyed. Unless a card says otherwise, tokens cannot be repaired.

Drones

Some attacks summon drones. A drone is a token that will take the action on the card that summoned it every turn (including the turn that it is summoned), except that it moves with its own movement value (the one

next to its health bar). The drone has a health stat indicated on the card that summoned it, which should stay in play until the drone is destroyed. The drone, like other tokens, cannot block.



Deck Construction

Each mobile suit must have a deck. To construct a deck, you first choose the frame. That frame has a stats card with the following information:

- Base movement
- Faction
- Armor values at each location
- Deck size 
- Weapon count 
- Booster count 
- Frame ability (if any)

The frame's deck must have exactly the numnber of cards in its deck size count in it. To build the deck, you can have:

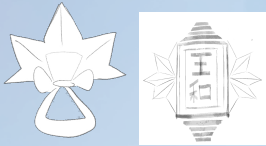
- Max 4 pilot cards, all from the same pilot, no duplicates
- Max X booster cards, where X is the frame's booster count (duplicates allowed)
- Up to N weapons where N is the frame's weapon count. Each weapon is a set of 4 attack cards. For each weapon slot you can include up to 1 of each card in that weapon.
- 1 of each of the generic cards

If any card has a faction logo on it, it can only be in a deck for a frame of that faction.

The Factions

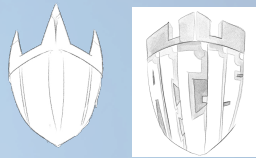
There are 6 main factions vying for control of the city, using their frames to exert their influence over their domain and contest territory with one another.

The Ouwa



Regal samurai with a keen sense of honor, they are the original creators of the frames, responsible for averting the destruction of the city when the nukes hit. They consider themselves the rightful rulers of the city, and will brook no disrespect, of which there is much.

The Aegis

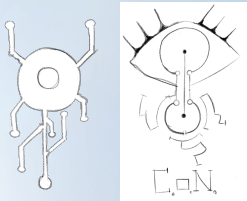


The Aegis see themselves as the last bastion against disorder. TODO

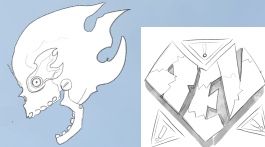
The Guild



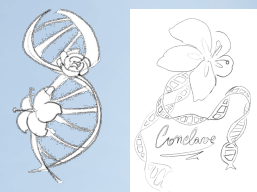
The Church of the Net

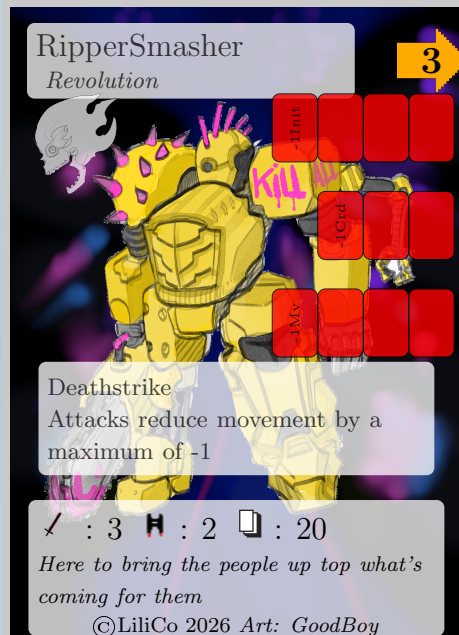


The Revolution



The Collective





Ability Keywords

On Hit:	The ability text after the colon only applies if the attack hits (that is, is not blocked)
Guard Break	This attack consumes a block for each zone. Zones that are not blocked deal damage.
Committed	this attack is consumed after it resolves
Feint	if this attack is not blocked, it deals no damage
on strike: (X)	if this attack hits (is not blocked), then X happens
Flying	This frame does not spend movement to cross obstacles or move between floors. Terrain of less than 1 level height does not block LoS to or from this frame.
Shield (X)	When a card with shield (X) resolves, or a frame with shield (X) starts, put X shield counters on the frame card. A frame can only have 1 more shield than it's shield value. The next time the frame would take any amount of damage, instead remove one shield counter from the frame.
Deathstrike	When this frame would be destroyed, they continue to fight until the end of the next turn, after which they are removed from play if they are still dead (they can be repaired)
Knockback (X)	Move the target frame X steps in any direction away from the source (ignore descent)

Example Frame deck for RipperSmasher (20 cards, 3 weapons, 2 boosters):

count	type	group	cards
3	pilot	bruiser	Relentless Assault, Intimidate, Net Strength
2	booster		Accelerate, Accelerate
4	weapon	Chainsaw	Rip, Grind, Tear, Disembowel
4	weapon	Cannon	Fullbore, Airburst, Cannon, Pummel
4	weapon	Cannon	Fullbore, Airburst, Cannon, Pummel
3	Generic		Block, Block, Dodge